Breakout thresholds by type

Gates a player must clear to stay on the waiver list, set from 2021-22 through 2025-26 season lines. The waiver selector uses these gates. The defensive wing under +8 is the one row that stays research only.

8 games
Sample where z becomes a filter

+8.0 mpg
Same-team minute gate

7.9
Toumani Camara gap, the one durable miss

Two clocks
Under 8 games, z-sum does not remove a same-team, team-change, vacated-shot, or no-prior starter. From the 8th game, z-sum removes everyone except specialists. Specialists are removed only when their minutes or the rate that qualified them falls off.

Entry and exit by type

Type	Gets in	Filtered later	Case on the line
Same-team minutes	Same team. Season mpg − last year ≥ 8.0. At least 1 game.	From game 8, 9-cat z-sum below last year.	Trey Murphy III +17.1, Christian Braun +13.7, Coby White +13.1, Amen Thompson +9.8 stay. Josh Hart +4.2 and Toumani Camara +7.9 are out.
Team change	Team changed. Season mpg strictly above last year. Any size of increase.	Season mpg falls back to last year or below. z-sum is not the filter.	Dyson Daniels +11.5, Nickeil Alexander-Walker +8.1, and Lauri Markkanen +3.6 stay. Josh Hart's 2022-23 trade lost minutes, so he is out.
Vacated shots	Same team. FGA ≥ +4.0. Season mpg ≥ 28. Minute gap may be under 8.	From game 8, z-sum down, or the FGA gap falls under 4.0.	Norman Powell +5.7 FGA and 32.6 mpg stays. A +2 FGA bump is out.
Defensive wing under +8	Same team. mpg ≥ 30. Gap ≥ 7.0 and under 8.0. Steals ≥ 1.3.	From game 8, z-sum down, or steals fall under 1.3.	Toumani Camara 32.7 mpg, +7.9, 1.5 steals stays. Norman Powell 1.2 steals does not use this gate. Research only.
Specialist, 20–28 mpg	20 ≤ mpg < 28, and one of: stocks ≥ 2.0, threes ≥ 2.0, rebounds ≥ 8.0, blocks ≥ 2.0. Needs 3 games.	Last 7 games: mpg under 20, or the qualifying rate misses. z-sum does not remove them. A point drop does not either.	Isaiah Hartenstein, Naz Reid, Walker Kessler, Keon Ellis stay. Adem Bona's 15.6 mpg season does not.
No prior NBA season	Games 1–7: mpg ≥ 28. z-sum ignored. From game 8: mpg ≥ 28 and z-sum held, or mpg ≥ 24 with a projection gap of at least 5 and z-sum held.	mpg under 24, or a 24–28 minute role that is not 5 minutes above the projection.	Herbert Jones at 29.9 stays from the second game. Walker Kessler at 23.0 uses the specialist gate instead.
Last 7 games	The same gates, applied to the last 7 games against last year. Not the diluted season average.	The last 7 games miss the gate.	Isaiah Hartenstein in December, Quentin Grimes in Philadelphia, Adem Bona in April.
Scoring fade	Not an entry gate.	At least 8 games. Last-7 mpg still ≥ 24. Last-7 points ≤ the season average by 4.0 or more. A specialist stays.	Jaime Jaquez Jr.: December 16.1 points, February 10.1, still 28.4 mpg. Out in February.

Stocks are steals plus blocks. Gaps are season minutes, attempts, or counting stats minus the previous season. These rows are the waiver selector, except the defensive wing under +8. The recent window is the ESPN last-7 split.

Who these gates keep and drop

Player	Breakout season	Measured line	Gate that decides	Result
Trey Murphy III	2022-23	+17.1 mpg, 31.0 mpg, 2.6 threes	Same-team ≥ 8	Keep
Christian Braun	2024-25	+13.7 mpg, 4 starts to 77	Same-team ≥ 8	Keep
Coby White	2023-24	+13.1 mpg, FGA +7.3	Same-team ≥ 8	Keep
Amen Thompson, year 2	2024-25	+9.8 mpg, 1.4 steals, 1.3 blocks	Same-team ≥ 8	Keep
Lauri Markkanen	2022-23	+3.6 mpg, FGA +5.8, new team	Team change	Keep
Dyson Daniels	2024-25	NOP 22.3 to ATL 33.8 mpg, steals 1.4 to 3.0	Team change	Keep
Nickeil Alexander-Walker	2025-26	MIN 25.3 to ATL 33.4 mpg, 9.4 to 20.8 points	Team change	Keep
Josh Hart	2024-25	NYK 33.4 to 37.6 mpg, FGA +1.6	Same-team ≥ 8	Miss. Gap is +4.2.
Toumani Camara	2024-25	+7.9 mpg, 32.7 mpg, 1.5 steals	Wing gap ≥ 7 and steals ≥ 1.3	Keep on the research row. Plain +8 drops him.
Norman Powell	2024-25	+6.4 mpg, FGA +5.7, 32.6 mpg	Vacated shots	Keep. Plain +8 drops him.
Isaiah Hartenstein	2023-24	25.3 mpg, 2.3 stocks, 8.3 rebounds	Specialist	Keep from December, not October
Naz Reid	2023-24	24.2 mpg, 2.1 threes	Specialist threes ≥ 2	Keep
Walker Kessler	2022-23	23.0 mpg, 2.3 blocks, no prior year	Specialist blocks ≥ 2	Keep
Keon Ellis	2024-25	24.4 mpg, 2.3 stocks	Specialist stocks ≥ 2	Keep. Plain +8 drops him.
Herbert Jones	2021-22	29.9 mpg from game 2, 1.7 steals, no prior year	No prior, mpg ≥ 28	Keep
Amen Thompson, rookie	2023-24	12.7 mpg in December, 26.9 in February, 30.1 in April	No prior	Out until the month he clears 28, or 24 if he is the confirmed starter
Quentin Grimes	2024-25	33.7 mpg over 28 games after 22.8 in Dallas	Recent window, team change	Keep once the Philadelphia games exist
Adem Bona	2024-25	15.6 mpg, 1.6 stocks	20 mpg floor	Filter
Jaime Jaquez Jr.	2023-24	28.4 mpg, 10.1 points after a 16.1-point December	Scoring fade, points −4	Filter. Minutes alone would keep him.

Breakout season is the year the measured line happened, not the year the role was still there. Amen Thompson is two rows: rookie 2023-24, then the minute jump in 2024-25. Keon Ellis stocks are 1.5 steals plus 0.8 blocks in 2024-25, up from 17.2 minutes in 2023-24.

Breakouts by season

The gates are not a 2024-25 rule with older names attached. Every season from 2021-22 through 2025-26 has at least one player the waiver list would add. 2024-25 is crowded because several shapes arrived in the same year, including the two that miss a plain +8.

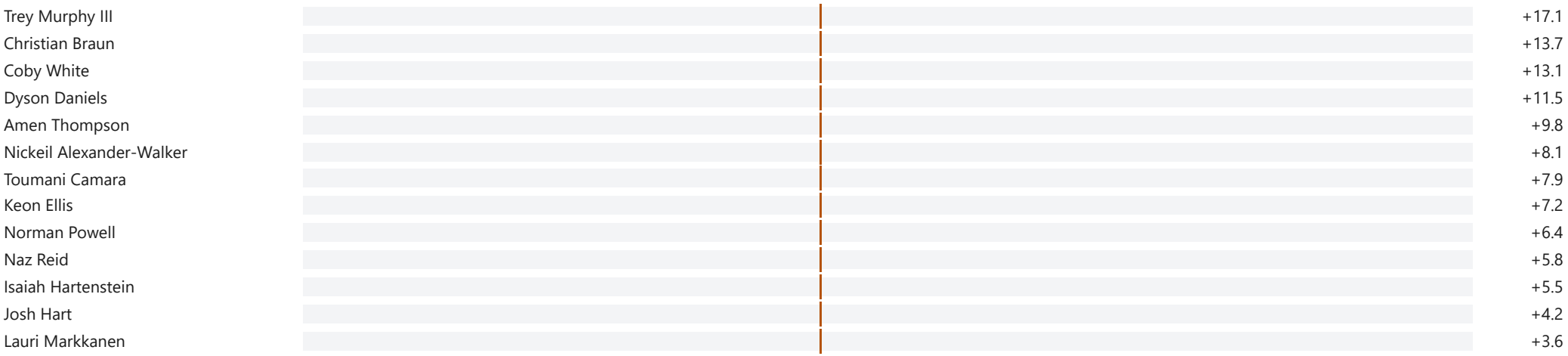
Season	Waiver list adds	On the table, not added
2021-22	Herbert Jones, no prior role	None
2022-23	Trey Murphy III, same-team minutes. Lauri Markkanen, team change. Walker Kessler, blocks.	None
2023-24	Coby White, same-team minutes. Isaiah Hartenstein and Naz Reid, specialists.	Amen Thompson stays out until April. Jaime Jaquez Jr. is the scoring fade.
2024-25	Christian Braun and Amen Thompson, same-team minutes. Dyson Daniels and Quentin Grimes, team change. Norman Powell, vacated shots. Keon Ellis, stocks.	Josh Hart misses at +4.2. Toumani Camara misses plain +8. Adem Bona's season average misses.
2025-26	Nickeil Alexander-Walker, team change.	Dyson Daniels and Josh Hart are follow-ups, not new adds. Dyson Daniels held the minutes. Josh Hart gave them back.

Where Josh Hart, Dyson Daniels, and Nickeil Alexander-Walker land

Dyson Daniels and Nickeil Alexander-Walker changed teams and gained minutes, so the list keeps them. Josh Hart's 2024-25 jump was 33.4 to 37.6 on the Knicks, a gain of 4.2. His 2022-23 trade from Portland cut minutes from 33.4 to 30.0. Neither season clears a gate.

Change in minutes per game from the previous season

Minutes per game versus the previous season. The amber line is the same-team gate of +8. Dyson Daniels is 2023-24 to 2024-25. Nickeil Alexander-Walker is 2024-25 to 2025-26. Josh Hart is 2023-24 to 2024-25. Source: Basketball-Reference.



Bar length is the minute gap. Scale runs to +18. The amber mark is +8.0.

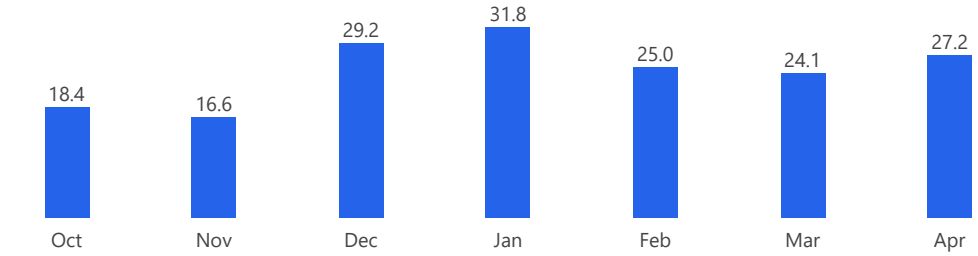
Six shapes

Shape	What actually moved	Season line	Current list
Vacated shots	Teammate leaves or stays out. Field-goal attempts jump more than minutes.	Norman Powell, LAC, 2024-25: 26.2 to 32.6 mpg, 10.1 to 15.8 FGA, 13.9 to 21.8 points. Starts 3 to 60. Kawhi out, Paul George gone.	Caught. Same team, FGA at least +4, mpg at least 28. z-sum applies from game 8.
Specialist at 20–28 mpg	Blocks, rebounds, steals, or threes. The minute load never looks like a starter.	Isaiah Hartenstein 2023-24: 19.8 to 25.3 mpg, 8.3 rebounds, 1.2 steals, 1.1 blocks. Naz Reid 2023-24: 18.4 to 24.2 mpg, 13.5 points, 2.1 threes. Walker Kessler 2022-23 rookie: 23.0 mpg, 2.3 blocks.	Caught inside 20–28 mpg when stocks, threes, rebounds, or blocks clear the line. z-sum does not remove them.
No prior NBA role	Nothing to compare with last year. The role appears inside the first season.	Herbert Jones 2021-22: 3 minutes in the opener, starter the next game, 29.9 mpg and 1.7 steals. Amen Thompson as a rookie: 12.7 mpg in December 2023, 30.1 in April 2024.	Caught at 28 mpg through game 7 with no projection check. After game 8 the role must hold on z-sum, and a 24–28 minute role also needs 5 minutes over the projection.
Arrives after opening month	October minutes are ordinary. The rosterable stretch starts in December, February, or April.	Isaiah Hartenstein opened at 18.4 and 16.6 mpg, then 29.2 in December. Quentin Grimes on the 76ers, 2024-25: 28 games, 33.7 mpg, usage 27.5 after 22.8 mpg in Dallas. Adem Bona's season was 15.6 mpg; the last month was 29.4 mpg, 13.8 points, 8.3 rebounds, 2.5 blocks.	Caught when the last 7 games clear the same gates, even if the season average does not.
Team-change scoring	New team, small minute bump, large attempt and point jump.	Lauri Markkanen, CLE to UTA, 2022-23: 30.8 to 34.4 mpg, FGA 11.5 to 17.3. Dyson Daniels, NOP to ATL, 2024-25: 22.3 to 33.8 mpg, steals 1.4 to 3.0. Nickeil Alexander-Walker, MIN to ATL, 2025-26: 25.3 to 33.4 mpg, 9.4 to 20.8 points, FGA 7.5 to 15.3.	Already caught. Any minute increase after a team change passes, and attempts are labeled.
Hot month, minutes stay	Scoring cools. Minutes do not. A minute rule keeps a player whose categories have faded.	Jaime Jaquez Jr., rookie 2023-24: December 33.6 mpg and 16.1 points, February 28.4 mpg and 10.1 points. March still 27.1 mpg.	Dropped. Last-7 points at least 4 below the season line, with minutes still at 24 or more. A specialist with the same point drop stays.

Norman Powell, Isaiah Hartenstein, Naz Reid, Walker Kessler, Lauri Markkanen, Jaime Jaquez Jr., Amen Thompson, and Quentin Grimes usage: Basketball-Reference. Herbert Jones's opener: NBA.com Pelicans season review. Adem Bona's final month: RotoWire 2024-25 waiver recap. Quentin Grimes minutes are 943 in 28 Philadelphia games and 1,070 in 47 Dallas games.

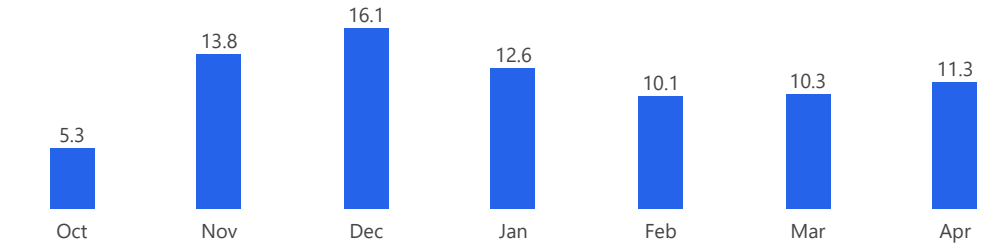
Isaiah Hartenstein minutes, 2023-24

Minutes per game by month. The useful role started in December, after Mitchell Robinson was out. Source: Basketball-Reference splits.



Jaime Jaquez Jr. points, rookie 2023-24

Points per game by month. Minutes stayed in the high 20s after the scoring cooled. Source: Basketball-Reference splits.



Same-team jumps that clear +8

These four cleared +8 minutes on the same team, so the list takes them. Josh Hart's own Knicks jump was +4.2, from a base that was already 33.4 minutes. That is a different case from a 20-minute player becoming a starter.

Player	Seasons	Minutes	What changed	Counting line
Trey Murphy III	2021-22 to 2022-23	+17.1	Same team. Shooter inherited minutes.	13.9 to 31.0 mpg, 2.6 threes, 14.5 points
Christian Braun	2023-24 to 2024-25	+13.7	KCP left. Bench wing became a starter.	20.2 to 33.9 mpg, 4 to 77 starts, 7.3 to 15.4 points
Coby White	2022-23 to 2023-24	+13.1	LaVine and the point-guard spot. Usage and minutes together.	23.4 to 36.5 mpg, 8.0 to 15.3 FGA, 2.8 to 5.1 assists
Amen Thompson	2023-24 to 2024-25	+9.8	Second year. Stocks, not a shot diet.	22.4 to 32.2 mpg, 1.4 steals, 1.3 blocks, 14.1 points

Toumani Camara was the near miss on this gate: 24.8 to 32.7 mpg (+7.9), steals 0.9 to 1.5. Josh Hart at +4.2 is not that near miss. He was already playing 33 minutes.

2025-26 lines

2025-26 is in the set as the year after the role appeared, except for Nickeil Alexander-Walker, whose breakout year is 2025-26 itself. A role that is still there the next season is the one worth adding in the first weeks.

Player	Breakout line	2025-26 line	Reading
Norman Powell	2024-25 LAC, 32.6 mpg, 21.8 points	Miami, 58 games, 29.6 mpg, 21.7 points	The shot role survived the trade off the Clippers.
Toumani Camara	2024-25, 32.7 mpg, +7.9	82 games, 33.3 mpg, 13.4 points	The jump that missed +8 became the job.
Amen Thompson	2024-25, 32.2 mpg, +9.8	79 games, 37.4 mpg, 18.3 points, 1.5 steals	The stocks role grew again.
Dyson Daniels	2024-25 ATL, 33.8 mpg, 14.1 points, 3.0 steals	76 games, all starts, 33.2 mpg, 11.9 points, 2.0 steals, 5.9 assists	Minutes held. Steals fell from 3.0 to 2.0. Not a new add.
Nickeil Alexander-Walker	2024-25 MIN, 25.3 mpg, 9.4 points, 10 starts	ATL, 78 games, 71 starts, 33.4 mpg, 20.8 points, 3.2 threes, FGA 15.3	This is the breakout year. Team change, +8.1 minutes.
Josh Hart	2024-25 NYK, 37.6 mpg, 13.6 points, 9.6 rebounds, 5.9 assists	66 games, 52 starts, 30.2 mpg, 12.0 points, 7.4 rebounds, 4.8 assists	The high-30s role did not hold. Minutes fell by 7.4.

2025-26: Basketball-Reference for Toumani Camara, Amen Thompson, Dyson Daniels, Nickeil Alexander-Walker, and Josh Hart. RealGM for Norman Powell. 2026-27 has just started, so it is not in this set.

Do these three move a threshold?

No gate number changes. Dyson Daniels and Nickeil Alexander-Walker already pass the team-change rule. Josh Hart is a real miss, and lowering +8 to catch him would add a different kind of player. His 2025-26 line then gave the extra minutes back.

Gate	What the three seasons do	Change the number?
Team change, any minute gain	Dyson Daniels +11.5 and Nickeil Alexander-Walker +8.1 pass. Josh Hart's 2022-23 trade lost minutes, 33.4 to 30.0.	No. Both sit above Lauri Markkanen's +3.6, so they do not raise the floor.

Gate	What the three seasons do	Change the number?
Same team, +8.0 minutes	Josh Hart +4.2, from 33.4 to 37.6, with FGA only +1.6. Dyson Daniels and Nickeil Alexander-Walker changed teams.	No. +4.2 would pull in players who were already at 33 minutes. Toumani Camara at +7.9 is still the near miss.
Vacated shots, FGA +4 and 28 minutes	Josh Hart's attempts rose 8.4 to 10.0. Dyson Daniels and Nickeil Alexander-Walker changed teams, so this gate does not apply.	No. Josh Hart is 2.4 attempts short, and he was not a shot-vacancy case.
Specialist, 20–28 minutes	Breakout minutes were 33.8, 33.4, and 37.6. Dyson Daniels had 3.7 stocks. Nickeil Alexander-Walker had 3.2 threes.	No. Raising the ceiling into the 30s would duplicate the team-change rule.
No prior season, last 7, scoring fade	All three had a prior NBA season. The fade rule is a within-season point drop, not a year-over-year one.	No. Dyson Daniels' 2025-26 steal drop is not a new entry, and it is not the fade exit.